

Meridian Valley General Hospital

Patient Access & Admissions Department Patient Admission Policies & Procedures Manual

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1. Purpose

This manual defines the standard workflow for registering and admitting patients at Meridian Valley General Hospital, covering scheduled admissions, emergency department (ED) admissions, direct transfers, and observation status placement.

2. Types of Admission

Admission Type	Description	Typical Authorization
Elective/Scheduled	Pre-booked procedure or planned inpatient stay	Pre-cert obtained 3-5 days prior
Emergency (via ED)	Patient admitted following ED evaluation	Concurrent review within 24 hrs
Direct Admission	Physician sends patient directly to unit, bypassing ED	Physician order + bed request
Observation Status	Short-stay for monitoring, <48 hrs expected	Condition Code 44 if converted
Transfer-In	Patient transferred from another facility	Accepting physician + bed confirmed

3. Standard Admission Workflow

- Step 1 - Pre-Registration: Demographics, insurance, and emergency contact captured by phone or online patient portal 24-72 hours before a scheduled admission.
- Step 2 - Identity Verification: Two patient identifiers required (full name + date of birth) at every check-in point, per National Patient Safety Goal NPSG.01.01.01.
- Step 3 - Insurance Verification & Financial Counseling: Eligibility checked in real time; patients with high out-of-pocket balances are offered a financial counseling consult before admission.
- Step 4 - Consent: General Consent for Treatment and Notice of Privacy Practices signed and scanned into the EHR. Procedure-specific informed consent obtained separately by the treating clinician.
- Step 5 - Armband & Wristband ID: Color-coded wristbands applied (white = standard ID, red = allergy, yellow = fall risk, purple = DNR/limited code status).
- Step 6 - Bed Assignment: Bed Control coordinates placement based on acuity, isolation needs, and unit census; average time from bed request to assignment target is under 45 minutes.
- Step 7 - Handoff to Unit: Nursing report given by ED or admitting physician using SBAR format (Situation-Background-Assessment-Recommendation).

4. Wristband Color Code Reference

Color	Meaning
White/Standard	Primary patient identification (name, DOB, MRN)
Red	Known allergy (medication, latex, food, or environmental)
Yellow	Fall risk - Morse Fall Scale score ≥ 45
Purple	DNR / Do Not Resuscitate or limited code status
Pink	Restricted extremity (no BP/blood draw on limb, e.g., dialysis fistula or mastectomy side)

5. Required Admission Documentation

- Photo ID and insurance card (front/back scanned)
- Signed General Consent for Treatment (Form ADM-C-01)
- Advance Directive / Healthcare Power of Attorney, if available (offered to every adult admission)
- Emergency contact and next-of-kin information
- Home medication list, reconciled with pharmacy within 24 hours of admission
- Insurance pre-authorization number, where applicable

6. Minor and Unaccompanied Patient Admissions

Patients under 18 require a parent or legal guardian to sign consent, except in emergencies where the Emancipated Minor or Emergency Treatment Doctrine applies. Unaccompanied minors are held in a supervised area and Social Work is notified immediately per policy ADM-C-09.

7. Bed Control and Census Management

The Bed Control Center (ext. 3100, staffed 24/7) manages real-time bed status across all 312 licensed beds. Units update bed status in the EHR bed board within 15 minutes of a discharge, transfer, or admission. Daily bed huddles occur at 8:00 AM, 12:00 PM, and 4:00 PM involving charge nurses, Bed Control, and the House Supervisor.

8. Discharge & Transfer Coordination

Anticipated discharge date (ADD) is documented within 24 hours of admission and updated daily on interdisciplinary rounds. Case Management screens all admissions within 24 hours for discharge planning needs, post-acute placement, and payer authorization requirements.

9. Contact

Patient Access & Admissions, Main Lobby, Level 1 | Registration Desk: ext. 3000 | Bed Control: ext. 3100 |
Financial Counseling: ext. 3050 | Available 24 hours / 7 days a week.